

HOWARD REID

Director / Senior Director, Information Technology

Enterprise IT Operations & Infrastructure | Cybersecurity, Identity & Compliance | ERP, Cloud & AI Governance
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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Technology leader with 27+ years of end-to-end accountability for enterprise IT across multi-site, multi-company organizations spanning manufacturing, energy, healthcare, education, and professional services. Directed technology for a private equity portfolio of 27+ operating companies across 17 industries and roughly 5,000 endpoints, and for a seven-site U.S. manufacturer of roughly 3,000 endpoints, owning \$12M to \$15M budgets and leading 30+ technology professionals across U.S., India, and Eastern European teams. Depth across infrastructure and networking, cybersecurity and identity, ERP, cloud migration, service desk and asset lifecycle, and vendor governance, with enterprise platform selections run from RFI through competitive RFP to deployment. Currently architects and operates production AI systems personally, with governance and cost control enforced in code. ITIL v3 and CompTIA Security+ certified, based in the Dallas / Fort Worth Metroplex.

SIGNATURE IMPACT

- **\$5M+ in recurring annual synergies** delivered across 11 acquisitions, 6 ground-up company builds, and 3 divestitures, consolidating business systems, migrating data, and unifying identity and infrastructure.
- **\$750K in recurring annual savings** from Azure and Microsoft 365 optimization against a \$12M budget, plus \$400K removed from telecom, \$175K from provisioning labor, and 20% vendor cost reduction through competitive RFP with service levels improved.
- **35% infrastructure cost reduction** through network and platform modernization across a seven-site manufacturing business on a \$15M IT budget.
- **100% MFA adoption, enterprise Zero Trust, and an 85% reduction in security incidents** across roughly 5,000 endpoints, with NIST-aligned cybersecurity governance, disaster recovery, and security awareness training established.
- **Enterprise platform selections owned end to end** from RFI through competitive RFP to deployment: Okta identity, Cisco Meraki network, three ITSM platforms (Track-It, TeamDynamix, Freshservice), and two ERPs.
- **165+ servers migrated to Microsoft Azure** with a tested four-hour recovery time objective, 99% uptime sustained, and 30+ technology professionals led at 93% retention through continuous change.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Enterprise IT Strategy & Operations • Infrastructure, Network & Cloud • Cybersecurity Governance (NIST CSF) & Zero Trust • Identity & Access Management (SSO, MFA) • Enterprise Applications & ERP (Dynamics 365 / NAV, Epicor, Odoo) • IT Service Management (ITIL) & Service Desk Leadership • IT Asset & Device Lifecycle • Disaster Recovery & Business Continuity • Vendor, Contract & SLA Management • IT Budget Development & Cost Optimization • M&A Technology Integration • Multi-Site & Distributed Workforce Support • Executive Stakeholder Partnership • AI Adoption & Governance • Team Leadership & Coaching

Platforms & Frameworks: Microsoft Azure • Microsoft 365 & Entra ID • Active Directory • Okta • Cisco Meraki • Intune / MDM • VMware • Freshservice, TeamDynamix, Track-It • Power BI • Dynamics 365, Epicor, Odoo • NIST CSF • ITIL • Python, React/TypeScript, PostgreSQL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Technology Executive & Strategic Advisor

Sep 2024 to Present

North Richland Hills, TX

- Advise multi-company leadership teams on IT operating model design, infrastructure and security standards, platform and ERP selection, and support organization structure, including an ERP evaluation covering multi-entity consolidation requirements, vendor scoring, and migration onto Odoo.
- Build and operate production systems and AI automation personally, including 25+ scheduled Python services, a React operations dashboard, monitoring with dead-man switch alerting, and secrets management, keeping current with hands-on infrastructure and security practice.

Senior Director, Technology Operations, Infrastructure & Security

Jun 2023 to Aug 2024

Liberty Steel USA | Peoria, IL and Dallas, TX

- Owned all technology for a seven-site U.S. manufacturing business of roughly 3,000 endpoints on a \$15M IT budget, directing a 15-person internal organization, a dedicated ERP team, and an India-based outsourced support group.
- Directed network operations across seven locations, covering LAN/WAN connectivity, wireless, and site-level reliability, and cut infrastructure cost 35% through network and platform modernization.
- Established enterprise cybersecurity governance aligned to the NIST Cybersecurity Framework, covering firewall and perimeter controls, endpoint protection, vulnerability management, backup and disaster recovery, and recurring security awareness training.

- Replaced a legacy AS/400 environment with Epicor ERP across manufacturing operations, retiring decades of accumulated technical debt and moving the business onto a supportable modern platform.
- Stood up a centralized IT service desk on Freshservice, consolidating site-by-site support into one intake and escalation model, and served as senior escalation point for major incidents.
- Restructured the vendor ecosystem through competitive RFP and renegotiation for 20% cost optimization while raising service levels, rebuilding SLAs, service reviews, and escalation paths so provider performance was measured rather than assumed.

Senior Director of IT Strategy & Architecture

May 2021 to Jun 2023

Wilks Brothers LLC | Fort Worth, TX

- Set enterprise technology direction for a private equity holding company operating 27+ portfolio businesses across 17 industries, roughly 5,000 endpoints, and \$1.5B+ in annual revenue, owning a \$12M budget and a 30+ person technology organization.
- Delivered \$750K in recurring annual savings through Azure and Microsoft 365 optimization and consolidation of duplicate systems, licensing, and support contracts, and removed a further \$400K in annual telecom expense through carrier consolidation and renegotiation.
- Directed cloud migration of 165+ servers to Microsoft Azure, improving application performance and availability and reducing recovery time objective to four hours with tested backup and restore procedures.
- Ran the enterprise network platform RFI and RFP, selected Cisco Meraki, and phased the migration off legacy infrastructure across three years against end-of-life and end-of-support dates, so modernization rode a funded replacement cycle instead of becoming a capital event or a field disruption.
- Led enterprise Zero Trust implementation, hardening single sign-on, account provisioning and deprovisioning, permissions, and conditional access across every operating company, and built the technology governance framework defining intake, prioritization, investment approval, and reporting.

Director of IT Operations & Enterprise Solutions

May 2014 to May 2021

Wilks Brothers LLC | Fort Worth, TX

- Built the enterprise IT function from the ground up through the company's most acquisitive period, spanning 11 acquisitions, 6 ground-up company builds, and 3 divestitures, and delivering \$5M+ in recurring annual synergies.
- Led the identity and access management program end to end, running the RFI and competitive RFP, selecting Okta, and driving implementation to 100% MFA and single sign-on adoption across roughly 5,000 endpoints while cutting security incidents 85%.
- Selected and implemented centralized ITSM platforms (Track-It, then TeamDynamix), standardizing Incident, Request, and Change processes, asset records, and service reporting into a single surface.
- Owned hardware and software lifecycle for roughly 5,000 endpoints, including purchasing standards, imaging, deployment, refresh cycles, license compliance, inventory accuracy, and disposal, removing \$175K in annual provisioning labor through automation.
- Established an enterprise PMO standardizing project intake, prioritization, and delivery reporting; improved reliability from frequent outages to 99% uptime and achieved 21% budget optimization while sustaining 93% employee retention.

Manager of Client Services

Nov 2010 to May 2014

FTS International | Fort Worth, TX

- Led a 28-member client technology and executive support organization on a \$1.6M OPEX/CAPEX budget, covering three administrative offices plus remote offices, field camps, and mobile units at drill sites, sustaining 99% uptime.
- Delivered a 700-device PC refresh entirely with in-house staff, standardized hardware approval and imaging company-wide, and ran a Mobile Device Management selection from RFP through vendor demos to deployment.

EARLIER CAREER

Capgemini Energy & HCL America, Dallas, TX: Client Services Team Manager, delivering outsourced IT under contract and SLA to TXU Energy, Oncor, Luminant, and Energy Future Holdings with India-based delivery teams. • Yellowbook USA: IT Operations. • Northwest Texas Healthcare System, Amarillo, TX: IT Operations; led HIPAA training and technology standardization across physician offices and facilities.

EDUCATION, CERTIFICATIONS & COMMUNITY

Bachelor of Science, Information Technology, Network Administration | Western Governors University, 2014

ITIL v3 • CompTIA Security+ • CompTIA Project+ • Lean Six Sigma White Belt

Lead Goalkeeper Coach, Solar Soccer Club (ECNL Regional League NTX, 2024 to 2025); previously Hurst FC and Allegiance FC.